

FORM TP 2010008



TEST CODE **01218020**

JANUARY 2010

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION**

ENGLISH A

Paper 02 – General Proficiency

2 hours 40 minutes

04 JANUARY 2010 (a.m.)

You are advised to use 10 minutes to read the paper and select the questions that you will answer. Writing may begin during this time.

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Section A consists of **ONE** question. You **MUST** answer this question.
2. Section B consists of **TWO** questions. You **MUST** answer both questions from this section.
3. Section C consists of **THREE** questions. You **MUST** answer **ONE** question from this section.
4. Section D consists of **TWO** questions. You **MUST** answer **ONE** question from this section.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

Copyright © 2008 Caribbean Examinations Council ®
All rights reserved.

01218020/JANUARY/F 2010

SECTION A

(Suggested time: 35 minutes)

You MUST answer the question in this section.

1. **Read the following extract carefully and then write a summary in NOT MORE THAN 120 words. Your summary must be in continuous prose, in paragraph form, and, as far as possible, IN YOUR OWN WORDS. If you exceed the word limit only the first 120 words will be read and assessed.**

As seeds get better, much of the world's soil is getting worse and people are going hungry. Scientists say if they can get the world out of the economically triggered global food crisis, better soil will be at the root of the solution. Soils around the world are deteriorating with about one-fifth of the world's cropland considered degraded in some manner. The poor quality has cut production by about one-sixth. Some scientists consider it a slow-motion disaster. In sub-Saharan Africa, nearly 1 million square miles of cropland have shown a "consistent significant decline", according to a March 2008 report.

A generation ago, through better types of plants, Earth's food production exploded in what was then called "green evolution". Some people thought the problem of feeding the world was solved and moved on. However, developing these new "magic seeds" was the easy part. The crucial element, fertile soil, was missing. "The first thing to do is to have good soil," said Hans Herren, winner of the World Food Prize. "Even the best seeds can't do anything in sand and gravel."

The cause of the current global food crisis is mostly based on market forces, speculation and hoarding. But beyond the economics lie droughts and floods, plant diseases and pests, and all too often, poor soil. Soil and water issues "have been taken for granted", said soil scientist Rattan Lal. "It is a problem that is not going to be solved. It's going to get worse before it gets better."

The current crisis could have been avoided "if we, the world, had promoted fertilizer in Africa and we have known for ages it works," said Pedro Sanchez, Columbia University tropical agricultural director. In that way, the problem with soil is a prime example of a larger failing of agricultural science.

The staples of modern agricultural scientific techniques include irrigation, crop rotation, reduced tilling, use of fertilizers and improved seeds. "Fixing soil just isn't exciting enough to interest governments and charities," commented the leading researcher at the International Rice Research Institute, where they have been trying to pinpoint the right combination of nitrogen and fertilizer. "Better seeds work wonders, but finding money for soil health is difficult and because of that, less work accomplished."

*Adapted from "Poor soils ... and the food crisis".
Sunday Express, May 11, 2006, p. 37.*

(30 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

SECTION B

(Suggested time: 40 minutes)

Answer ALL questions in this section.

- 2. Read the following extract carefully and then answer all the questions set on it.**

5 Very few people in the village didn't like Joe. Many of the little children and some adults were afraid of him. Many didn't understand him. He seldom smiled, and no one could remember hearing him laugh. When he wasn't working intently at his workbench planing a piece of mahogany, shaping it, smoothing it, sanding it and finally polishing it, rubbing his calloused fingers caressingly along its length, seeming to get an almost sensual pleasure out of the brown wood, he would sit at the door of his little workshop gazing over the waves and out to sea. He would sit with his pipe firmly clenched between his teeth, never moving it from the right side of his mouth. No one had ever seen it lighted or smoke coming from the bowl, but it was always in his mouth.

10 His dark brown face was rugged and creased, with black eyes sheltered by bushy overhanging brows. His square jaw merged into a thick neck and broad shoulders, well-muscled from the many hours of sawing the heavy mahogany tree trunks into slabs and turning those slabs into pieces of furniture which were works of art. Joe was easy-going. He took his time walking, as if he was careful where he placed each step. He was equally unhurried in his work. If someone wanted work done, they placed an order for the table and chair. They never asked when it would be finished. They knew it would take time. They placed the order and waited.

15 Joe's furniture was the best. It was strong, durable and well-crafted. It was almost flawless. The dove-tailed joints fit together so closely that only extremely close examination showed where the pieces were joined. The glow of the polish belied many hours of sanding, smoothing, cleaning, polishing and shining. Some people still had Joe's furniture after thirty years, and the only difference about it from the day it had been delivered was the darkening of the wood as it got older.

*Alvin Cummins, The royal palms are dying.
Caribbean Chapters, 2008, pp. 8 – 9.*

- (a) What was Joe's occupation? (1 mark)
- (b) What does the passage suggest were the TWO favourite activities in Joe's life? (2 marks)
- (c) Give ONE reason why children would be afraid of Joe. (2 marks)
- (d) What is the evidence given to show that Joe loved working with wood? (2 marks)
- (e) Identify TWO ways in which Joe's daily work over the years had affected his body. (2 marks)
- (f) Quote TWO statements about the way the villagers behaved, to show that they understood Joe. (2 marks)
- (g) Joe's furniture is described as "durable". What evidence of this is given in the passage? (2 marks)
- (h) What statement in the final paragraph suggests that the joints on Joe's furniture were almost invisible? (2 marks)

Total 15 marks

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

3. Read the following extract carefully and then answer all the questions set on it.

Enjoyment on the Carnival Line

- Being able to do just what you want is called freedom. It's also called liberty. Which are the names of two of our most spectacular ships. What a coincidence. Because you can do just what you want on these floating resorts: play every game; hit every restaurant; or just lie beside the pool and watch movies day or night. On either ship, you're in for an all-time fantastic week on your choice of three itineraries. Sail to the Eastern Caribbean and you'll see San Juan, from Morro Castle to its hottest nightclubs. On St. Thomas, how about watersports in the morning and duty-free shopping in the afternoon? Or vice versa. On St. Maarten, expect some greetings to be "goedemorgen" or "bonjour" since it is half Dutch and half French. Opt for the Exotic Eastern Caribbean and your first stop is the lush, private island of Half Moon Cay with its tropical adventures. From there you sail to St. Thomas, San Juan and the divers' paradise Grand Turk with its new cruise center. If you're island-hopping in the Western Caribbean you can dive, sightsee and shop on Cozumel or explore Grand Cayman's wonders which include Seven Mile Beach and great wildlife attractions. Your last destination, Ocho Rios, may be most famous for Dunn's River Falls but you'll find many other reasons to love this Jamaican paradise.
- On the Carnival Valor, the fun's everywhere. If you love relaxing in the sun, you have a choice of three pool areas. If you plan to golf on the islands, our onboard pro can prepare you to challenge those gorgeous greens. If you love fine dining and dancing to live music, make your reservation at the supper club pronto. On her Eastern cruise your first stop is Nassau for duty-free shopping, seeing for yourself just how white the sand is and playing those golf courses we mentioned. St. Thomas has all that plus a hillside of shops at Charlotte Amalie. St. Maarten has its own charms, many of which are both Dutch and French. If you've decided on the Exotic Western itinerary, your endless photo ops will be in Grand Cayman; Isla Roatan; and Belize, where you'll be awed by its world-class zoo. But, wait, there's one more fabulous stop on this cruise: Cozumel, Mexico. Here you'll want to see one of Carnival's "Seven Wonders of the Caribbean" – Tulum, the site of the Mayan walled city. All of this fun is yours aboard the Carnival Line.

Adapted from "Carnival valor". Carnival the fun ships, Carnival cruise lines, 2007, pp. 60 – 61.

- (a) What are the names of TWO of Carnival Line's MOST spectacular ships? (2 marks)
- (b) What are the activities associated with being able "to do just what you want"? (2 marks)
- (c) How long does any ONE itinerary last? (1 mark)
- (d) What are the destinations on the Eastern Caribbean itinerary? (1 mark)
- (e) Explain the term "vice versa" as used in the line "... watersports in the morning and duty-free shopping in the afternoon? Or vice versa." (lines 6 and 7). (2 marks)
- (f) To what does "this Jamaican paradise" (line 14) refer? (1 mark)
- (g) (i) Give ONE activity experienced on *Carnival Valor* which is NOT mentioned in relation to the other ships. (1 mark)
- (ii) How does the ship help passengers with this activity? (1 mark)
- (h) Explain the expression: "... endless photo ops" (line 22). (2 marks)
- (i) What is the intention of the writer of this passage? (2 marks)

Total 15 marks

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

SECTION C

(Suggested time: 45 minutes)

Answer ONE question from this section.

Your answer in this section should be approximately 400 – 450 words in length.

You MUST write in Standard English. However, dialect may be used in conversation.

SHORT STORY

EITHER

4. Write a story based on the picture below.



*Heartline, Heart and Stroke Foundation of Barbados Inc.,
p. 4. Oct. – Dec. 2008.*

(35 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

OR

5. Write a story which begins or ends with the following sentences:

“He slammed the door behind him. He knew that it would be for the last time.”

(35 marks)

OR

DESCRIPTION

6. The rain and wind finally stopped after two days and then the people made their way out of the storm shelter.

Describe what they saw when they came out.

(35 marks)

SECTION D

(Suggested time: 30 minutes)

Answer ONE question from this section.

Your answer in this section should be approximately 250 to 300 words in length.

You MUST write in Standard English.

EITHER

7. **Speaker A:** I am going to start eating more local food because that is what makes our Caribbean Olympic athletes stars.

Speaker B: Nobody is going to get me to eat yams and sweet potatoes. That is backwardness.

Write an essay supporting the views of EITHER Speaker A OR Speaker B and justifying the kind of food that you prefer to eat.

(35 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

OR

8. Sexual and violent songs should be banned from the radio and television.

Write an essay giving your views on this statement.

(35 marks)

END OF TEST

The Council has made every effort to trace copyright holders. However, if any have been inadvertently overlooked, or any material has been incorrectly acknowledged, CXC will be pleased to correct this at the earliest opportunity.